Transform, creating an extension of the crust with consequent subsidence.

99. *Stage 1:* Rising limbs of the convectional currents create a mantle plume that tries to escape to the surface by up-warping the lithosphere. During up-warping, a series of faults are created. Both normal and thrust faults (reverse fault) occur during up-warping. Divergence of plates begin.

    *Stage 2:* Faulting due to divergence creates extensive rift system (fault zones, rift valleys). Rifting is followed by flood basalt volcanism in some places that spread around the rift creating plateaus, highlands etc. **East African Rift Valley** is at this stage of evolution.

    *Stage 3:* Rift valley deepens due to further divergence and makes way for ocean waters. If the rift valleys are formed deeper within the continents, rains waters accumulate forming rift lakes.

    *Stage 4:* Intense outpouring of basaltic magma accentuates see floor spreading and oceanic crust formation. Oceanic crust replaces the continental crust and a mighty ocean is formed.

100. Characteristics of Fold Mountains:
    - Fold mountains belong to the group of youngest mountains of the earth.
    - The presence of fossils suggest that the sedimentary rocks of these folded mountains were formed after accumulation and consolidation of silts and sediments in a marine environment.
    - Fold mountains extend for great lengths whereas their width is considerably small.
    - Generally, fold mountains have a concave slope on one side and a convex slope on the other.
    - Fold mountains are found along continental margins facing oceans.
    - Fold mountains are characterised by granite intrusions on a massive scale.
    - Recurrent seismicity is a common feature in folded mountain belts.